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**Pocket's iMessage App**

The new iMessage app from Pocket's makes browsing and sharing stories in chat so much easier. <http://dgit.in/iMsgPocket>

Build it, bring it

"You can't travel the world on a PowerPoint Deck", says Nick Earle, SVP, Hyperloop One, while announcing his company's plans for India



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Q We just talked about connecting a billion people, but the Hyperloop can take only about 28 people at a time, right? What's the possibility of scaling the number of passengers?

Nick: To be clear, the pod doesn't take just 28 people at a time. The pods have a variable length and it's an autonomous vehicle. They move, let's say about 20 seconds apart. So, the pod could take maybe 60 people at a time. But to your point, it's not 6,000 people. However, 60 people every 20 seconds is still quite a few people.

Now, if you have a network of Hyperloops, you can change the lives of a billion people. If we had a fibre access between here and the building next to us, it wouldn't change Delhi. However, when the Internet let you reach out to London or anywhere else, it changed people's lives.

In terms of ridership, we're looking at anywhere from low-end 6,000 passengers per hour to a high-end 20-25,000 per hour. If we need more, you just build another pipe.

Q How do you plan on taking up specific challenges imposed by coun-

tries? Or how are you going to localise Hyperloop in various countries?

Nick: We're actually open to localising the design. One of the biggest advantages of being amongst the first countries to adopt is that we actually can take inputs from these countries. For example, one of the first regulators we've worked with are in Dubai. They've set specific requirements in order for us to get safety certifications. So, we agree and accordingly start working on the redesign.

Now, what we don't want to do is design different Hyperloops for every country, based on their specific and intricate certifications. Although, the first iterations being built will definitely influence the design over the rest of the world.

We're creating a configurable system that can be adapted universally. We're also building interoperability standards so that different transportation systems can physically connect to each other. This way Hyperloop systems from different companies can work together.

Note: A study conducted by Hyperloop in connecting Stockholm to Finland found that the price of travelling in a Hyperloop was a tenth of the airfare of the same distance. The ticket

prices were about €28 which converts to around ₹2,000.

Q Interoperability with other public transport systems is important. The existing transport systems are primitive, so how do you plan on establishing a seamless system?

Nick: I wouldn't say primitive but earlier technology, yes. We've actually talked to Deutsche Bahn about this at length. It was concluded that interoperability wasn't a key requirement.

We're building interoperability from day one. Being from CISCO, we know how this is important. It wasn't the only networking company, but it created open standards. We as a company have the opportunity to publicise our standards and while being independent bodies, others will decide the standards as well.

We'll never be able to interoperate within the software in a Siemens train. The app that allows you to get the timetable, enter your credit card info and book, can be linked through open APIs. So, an Uber can be linked. We can have interoperability at the application level and with autonomous cars in future, and between different Hyperloop suppliers, because there will be more suppliers in future. **Q**